



Content prediction is the holy grail for the media industry

necessarily as a flash of inspiration but as an amalgamation of carefully selected data points. Knowing what your audience wants gives a media company an obvious advantage over their rivals. And one fine example of a company making use of the “predictive knowledge” that big data brings is the bidding war between HBO, AMC and Netflix for the Kevin Spacey starrer show, *House of Cards*.

All the three companies did realise that the show would bring in a lot of money. However, it was Netflix that used better data for their bidding. Their bidding was based on their fine-tuned analysis of viewing habits that took into consideration millions of showings. The analysis gave them insights into the types of shows that engaged the audience and realising that *House of Cards* was in that category, they gained enough confidence to make a bolder bid for the show, which led to them winning it.

LEARN BIG DATA WITH THE BESTSELLING BOOK



Big Data: A Revolution That Will Transform How We Live, Work, and Think is the first major book on the topic. Authored by Viktor Mayer-Schönberger and Kenneth Cukier, the book explains the hard topic in 272 pages and was selected as the finalist in Financial Times Business Book of the Year.